Healthy Together

Department of Health and Human Services

Request for Information; Health Technology Ecosystem

RFI CMS-0042-NC

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Executive Summary

Healthy Together is pleased to respond to the Department of Health and Human Services Request for Information for a Health Technology Ecosystem.

Healthy Together's mission is to make our government the best-run organization in the world. We deploy cloud-native Software as a Service (SaaS) solutions and systems that deliver outcomes for our government partners. We partner with our clients to understand key objectives and agency goals, rapidly configure and deploy bespoke solutions, and manage systems and programs to ensure efficacy and efficiency. These values drive the Healthy Together team to innovate often, fully understand the user's journey and personas, build trust, and elevate the level of service to its stakeholders.

Healthy Together integrates services such as eligibility determination, enrollment, recertification, reporting, data management and deduplication, and communication within a single, user-friendly suite of applications, ensuring a cohesive and efficient experience for residents and administrators alike.

Legacy systems and antiquated workflows result in extreme inefficiencies, employee burnout and frustration, and residents who have little transparency into their specific cases. Legacy systems suffer from a lack of data integration, scalability, automation, and outdated reporting. Healthy Together is supporting states nationwide to provide case management systems, integrated communication tools, automated and AI-agentic workflows, improved processes, robust reporting, and many other features for staff, administrators, and residents.

Since 2020, Healthy Together has been able to impact millions of staff and residents who have utilized the platform, with over 220,000 providing reviews, averaging a 98% overall satisfaction rating, validating the importance of user-friendly navigation, design, features, functionality, and experience.

Healthy Together provides a full range of flexible capabilities, enabling states and federal agencies to have a true, end-to-end solution for staff, providers, and residents, including:

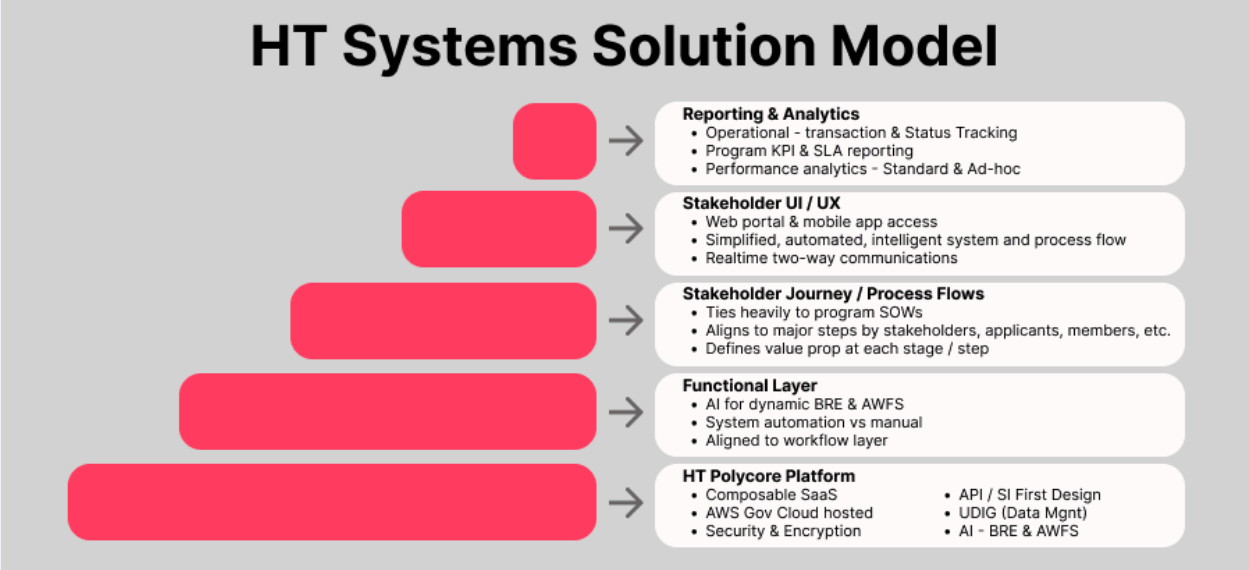
- An interoperable SaaS platform, built on Polycore, that integrates and scales across networks
- Adaptable modules that bring new workflows to existing processes and leverage AI automation, digital services, and integration to provide the best user experience
- Analytics capabilities to drive real-time reporting, convenient data exports, and insights available via web, mobile web, or mobile application
- Flexible modes of accessibility via web, mobile web, and mobile app development and support

Healthy Together has delivered proven and battle-tested solutions to state agencies at scale. Healthy Together has been deployed to support CMS and FNS programs in Florida, Missouri, Michigan, Oklahoma, Maryland, Virginia, Alaska, Montana, Chickasaw Nation, Choctaw Nation, and the Department of Veterans Affairs, which have taken advantage of a combination of different modules of the Healthy Together platform. Healthy Together solves some of the nation's most complex challenges within health and human services. The result of Healthy Together's dedication and passion to solving these complex challenges through a modular and flexible platform results is a swift delivery of user-focused technology and a future-facing strategy to serve the people, and an efficient workflow for staff, providers, and residents to drive safer and healthier outcomes.

Healthy Together has been adopted by millions of users and has become one of the most reviewed and liked applications in the Health space, with over 220,000 reviews in the app stores and an average 4.9 out of 5 stars rating. This shows users' overwhelming approval, adoption and engagement of the Healthy Together software.

Government Systems Built on Polycore

The Healthy Together solution is engineered with modern design, technology, and capabilities, breaking from legacy constraints. The system's architecture model is purpose-built for change; to be easy and flexible and able integrate changes and to be simple to configure with unparalleled speed. The graphic below highlights the Healthy Together model which can enable and empower Medicare, state Medicaid programs, and other HHS programs with a comprehensive and integrated set of capabilities. These range from the highly flexible foundation/platform layer to the outcomes/performance-based level of transparency and control at the disposal of CMS. This approach solves problems and removes obstacles for States, residents, providers, and service partners.



Polycore is based on a new and innovative technology design, purpose-built for change. Our Polycore platform differentiates itself from legacy systems in the following ways:

- **The Polycore Platform Architecture** – purpose-built for change, highly elastic.
  - ***Polymorphic Data Infrastructure*** components for data, business rules, software code, BRE, and workflows, etc, are designed to be flexible, not hard-coded
  - ***"API First"*** - establishes a robust, standardized framework that streamlines data exchange and enables seamless system integrations, ultimately accelerating innovation and reducing deployment complexities
  - ***Unified Data Ingestion & Governance (UDIG) Engine*** - masters data exchange and management. Creates relationships to leverage preexisting data from other State program systems to drive QC validations and streamline workflows
  - ***Composable SaaS*** – blends standard upgrade and release plan cycles with highly flexible client-driven ad-hoc change requests, using no-code/low-code system updates to deploy and test changes

- ***Integrated & AI-powered Business Rules Engine (BRE) & Automated Workflow (AWF)*** – The combination of these three integrated components is designed to manage program instructions and requirements to seamlessly automate and optimize workflow

At a base layer, we see that the design of Polycore integrates components with innovative capabilities that transform ***how*** systems and software are deployed, maintained, and used to foster program success. For Stakeholders and Program management, the following components help complement the solution.

- **Responsive Design / Native Mobile App**
  - Can be used without an internet connection; No waiting for static content (images and text) to be downloaded from the web
  - Optimized to work on any device or Operating System (i.e., iOS, Android, Google etc.)
  - Human-centered design drives a superior and magnificent user experience
  - Mulito-Language - intelligent applications launch with user-preferred language profile

- **Program Reporting & Analytics**
  - Event-based tracking supports internal data collection out of the box
  - Collects and reports on user-level transactions as well as different types of data across multiple providers and program types
  - Role-based security for easy access to providers and evaluators
  - Robust reporting tools for generating reports, program evaluation, and performance management reports

- **System Implementations & Change Requests**
  - Formerly known as DDIs, Healthy Together redefines the process and timelines to: Install, Configure and Optimize (ICO) our solution. This means time to deploy is cut materially from years down to months
  - Testing that required many, many months and teams of people from CDSS and Vendors to complete, is massively reduced which saves significant time and money

Benefits of Our Unique Approach

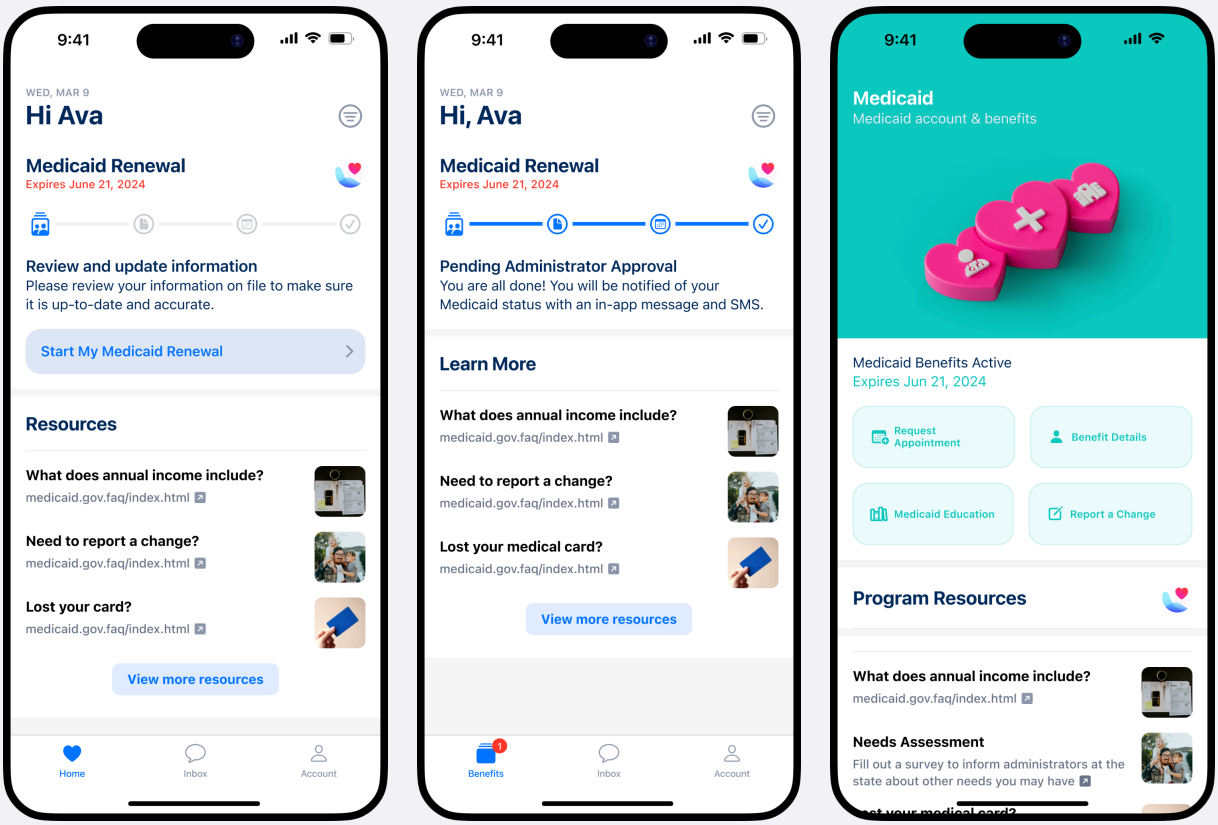
The Healthy Together solution provides world world-class member experience to the government's most crucial programs. Our state-of-the-art solution provides a platform that fundamentally provides greater flexibility, configurability, and scalability than other market options. The Healthy Together solution enables agencies to address immediate challenges related to member engagement and program administration, while still being able to continue current modernization projects without disruption. The benefits of our solution to augment legacy systems are tremendous and quickly improve program success. Why we are unique:

- **The Polycore Platform Architecture** – purpose-built for change, designed to be dynamically flexible.
  - ***Highly Elastic Operating System*** - data relationships, new or adjusted business rules, new functionality or workflow changes, are more easily applied to the systems via no-code or low-code software updates
  - ***Composable SaaS*** – is faster to implement updates and maintains a more current environment for technology, policy requirements and workflows
  - ***System Changes*** - are more transparent and less invasive; meaning the level of effort and time to complete testing and UAT is reduced
- **Advanced Automation** – Agentic AI creates a smart workflow management and automated system.
  - It learns and evolves over time, tailors' best practices for the program and user
  - Helps design new rules and changes to optimize performance and outcomes
- **Speed of Change** – Unprecedented speed to deploy or change systems in weeks/months, not years. The architecture model simplifies system design and maintenance; leverages the elasticity of software, data and components; drives down effort, and materially lowers risks and costs
- **Stakeholder Impact** – Through Mobile and Web based systems, stakeholder journeys are now more automated, intuitive, simpler and efficient.
  - Functionality not only automates most workflow steps but adjusts and tailors steps and activities to the individual type of user
  - This flexibility helps eliminate points of conflict, system constraints, and focuses on Stakeholder expectations
- **Flexibility, Scale & Elasticity** - the Healthy Together platform was intended to leverage, incorporate and scale to other HHS programs. This means one system to support the alignment and tech efficiencies from the core platform, driving performance optimization while still enabling each program to remain or operate with autonomous rules and service profiles.

Recommendations For Impact

Increasing Access to Care

Providers face immediate barriers to policy innovations and cost-cutting in Medicaid and Medicare due to outdated, consultant-built software and data systems. Providers, especially those in rural areas, find it difficult to bridge the gap between outdated processes and modern digital standards. Digital health products like the Healthy Together solution provide a modernized approach that significantly reduces the time, cost, and resources that are currently required by replacing labor-intensive manual processes. One of our clients reported that a single new enrollment can require up to 800 keyboard clicks using their existing Medicaid system. Patients are forced to wait in line to meet with a Medicaid administrator in order to submit a benefit application. Once submitted, applicants wait days or weeks to be enrolled in programs. Healthy Together systems are purpose-built to automate manual processes, eliminate bottle-necks, and allow benefit applicants to apply from the comfort of their homes, which saves providers time, money, and resources.



Improving Healthcare Outcomes

Healthy Together recommends the following to improve healthcare outcomes:

1. As state and territory agencies are already implementing Integrated Eligibility & Enrollment with other HHS and FNS programs, CMS should seek OMB A-87 waivers for any agency that wishes to integrate multiple programs into the state-run Medicaid system. The OMB A-87 waiver will reduce administrative and accounting challenges by allowing Medicaid agencies to cover the cost for smaller programs utilizing the IE&E system without seeking reimbursement from those programs, expediting the modernization process.

2. Cease funding Design, Develop & Implement (DD&I) models of legacy-style systems that cannot be modernized to the new standards: modularity, cloud-native, composable SaaS, event-based tracking, and polymorphic data models.

3. Provide state and territory agencies with a "Turbo-Tax" style system to facilitate and automate Advance Planning Document (APD) creation. Create a case management system that uses ML and AI to support CMS administrators in the APD review and approval process. Re-vamp the T-MSIS reporting process by requiring MMIS/MES to utilize event-based tracking. T-MSIS reporting is a key bottleneck for identifying opportunities to improve health outcomes and finding fraud. T-MSIS data submitted by state agencies is often incomplete, inaccurate, and not real-time. Some state agencies have not automated T-MSIS report creation, creating a significant burden on administrators to generate and transmit reports. By requiring event-based tracking in Claims Systems, CMS can future-proof the T-MSIS system by ensuring that all data is collected and ready for transmission and analysis at all times.

4. Create a system for ongoing management information system certification that uses open APIs, data flows, and interfaces for state and territory agencies to automatically maintain certification of their Enrollment & Eligibility and Medicaid Enterprise Systems. State and territory IE&E and MMIS/MES are required to comply with ongoing certification to receive funding for M&O. This process is cumbersome, time-consuming, and expensive, and can be automated with modern tools for data extraction, testing and automation. This system could be deployed as a standalone CMS system or as part of a CMS-provided "base operating system" which would have certification tools and reports pre-configured.

5. Explore ways these modern tools can be implemented to reduce cost and improve the efficacy of Medicare and other CMS programs.